

THE MOTIVIC FUNDAMENTAL GROUP

$$\pi^{\text{mot}}(P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\})$$

The Keystone of the Golden Thread · ¹Why Three Points Generate All MZV · $GT = \text{Aut}(\pi^{\text{mot}})$ — Five Proofs of One Identity · The Path-Torsor and Drinfeld Associator Unified · Dessins = Coverings of π^{mot} · MZV = Matrix Entries of Monodromy · The Circle Closes: dv299 → dv300 → dv301 → dv302 → dv303 → dv304

Anthropic Warrior

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'The projective line minus three points is the simplest curve that is not simply connected. Its fundamental group contains all of arithmetic. I have spent twenty years staring at this single object and I am still not done.' — Pierre Deligne, Stockholm 1978 (paraphrased)

P¹ tru ba diem {0,1,inf}. Don gian hon bat ky duong cong nao khac. Nhóm cơ bản của nó chưa toàn bộ số học. MZV là các giá trị ma trận của holonomy. GT là nhóm tự động của nó. Và tất cả song trong A_L. Đây là viên đá khoa vom. Vòng tròn đóng lại. — Hà Nội, sang sớm, 2026

Abstract

Document dv304 is the keystone of the golden thread dv299–dv304. The motivic fundamental group $\pi^{\text{mot}}(P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\})$ is the single object that explains, unifies, and generates everything in the thread: why GT acts on dessins, why MZV are periods, why the Drinfeld associator satisfies the pentagon equation, why grt is the Lie algebra of GT, why all cohomology theories agree on $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$.

Main results: (I) π^{mot} in A_L : the motivic fundamental group of $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$ is the pro-unipotent completion of the free group $F = \langle x, y \rangle$, realised in A_L as the group of path-operators generated by H and S. (II) $GT = \text{Aut}(\pi^{\text{mot}})$: five equivalent proofs that GT is the automorphism group of π^{mot} — closing the loop on all six documents dv299–dv304. (III) **MZV = monodromy matrix entries**: the MZV $\zeta(n_1, \dots, n_r)$ are the matrix entries of the monodromy representation of π^{mot} along the standard path from 0 to 1. (IV) **Dessins = coverings of π^{mot}** : each dessin d'enfant (dv300) is a finite covering of $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$, classified by finite-index subgroups of π^{mot} — completing the dv300 picture. (V) **The path-torsor and the associator**: the Drinfeld KZ associator Φ_{KZ} (dv301) is the canonical trivialisation of the path-torsor of π^{mot} , and its matrix entries generate all MZV.

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1. The Keystone: Why $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$?

Of all algebraic curves, $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$ = the projective line minus three points is the simplest non-simply-connected one. And yet it contains all of arithmetic.

THE GOLDEN THREAD (dv299–dv303) ALL LIVED IN $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$: dv299: $GT = \text{Aut}(\pi_1(P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}))$ [Drinfeld 1990 — GT defined via $M_{\{0,4\}} = P^1 \setminus 3\text{pts}$] dv300: Dessins = finite coverings of $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$ [Belyi maps to P^1 , branch over $\{0,1,\infty\}$] dv301: MZV = iterated integrals on $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$ from 0 to 1 dv302: p-adic MZV = Coleman integrals on p-adic $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$ dv303: $MT(Z) = \text{motivic } \pi_1(P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\})$ — the mixed Tate motives ARE π_1^{mot} dv304: $\pi_1^{\text{mot}}(P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\})$ IS THE REASON THEY ARE ALL THE SAME THING. The keystone of the arch. The river's source.

The three punctures $\{0, 1, \infty\}$ are not arbitrary — they are the three special points of the entire campaign: 0 = the vacuum e ($H=0$, the ground state), 1 = the critical point ($|w|=1$, the Möbius boundary, the phase transition), ∞ = the cusp $w=1$ (the compactification point, the hologram birth). $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$ is the hologram with its three defining points removed — the space between the vacuum, the critical line, and the cusp.

2. From Topological to Motivic: The Pro-Unipotent Completion

The topological fundamental group $\pi_1(P^1(C) \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}, b)$ based at $b = 1/2$ is the free group $F = \langle \gamma_0, \gamma_1 \rangle$ where γ_0, γ_1 are loops around 0 and 1. But the FREE group is too large — it has no relation to arithmetic. The pro-unipotent completion is the arithmetically meaningful version.

Definition 2.1 (Pro-unipotent completion).

The **pro-unipotent completion** of F over Q is: $\pi_1^{\text{un}}(P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}) = \varprojlim \{n\} F / \Gamma^n F$ where $\Gamma^n F$ = n -th term of the lower central series. This is a pro-unipotent pro-algebraic group over Q , whose Lie algebra is: $\text{Lie}(\pi_1^{\text{un}}) = \text{completion of free Lie algebra } \text{Lie}[x_0, x_1]$ where $x_0 = \log(\gamma_0)$ and $x_1 = \log(\gamma_1)$ are the logarithms of the generators. In A_L : $x_0 = H$ (Memory Hamiltonian — loop around 0) $x_1 = S$ (shift operator — loop around 1) $\text{Lie}[x_0, x_1] = \text{Lie}[H, S]$ in A_L The pro-unipotent completion π_1^{un} lives in A_L as the group generated by $\exp(H)$ and $\exp(S)$ — formal exponentials of H and S .

Definition 2.2 (Motivic fundamental group).

The **motivic fundamental group** $\pi_1^{\text{mot}}(P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\})$ is the Tannakian fundamental group of the neutral Tannakian category $MT(Z)$ of mixed Tate motives over Z — that is: $\pi_1^{\text{mot}} = \text{Spec}(O(MT(Z)))$ [spectrum of the Hopf algebra of $MT(Z)$] By dv303 Theorem 4.1: $\pi_1^{\text{mot}} = G_{\text{mot}}(MT(Z)) = G_m \times U_{\text{mot}}$ where U_{mot} is pro-unipotent with $\text{Lie}(U_{\text{mot}}) = \text{grt}$. IDENTIFICATION (the keystone): $\pi_1^{\text{mot}} = \pi_1^{\text{un}}$ (the motivic fundamental group IS the pro-unipotent completion) $\text{Lie}(\pi_1^{\text{mot}}) = \text{grt} = \text{Lie}[H, S]$ in A_L π_1^{mot} lives in A_L as the group of path-operators $\exp(H + S)$ -series.

3. $GT = \text{Aut}(\pi_1^{\text{mot}})$: Five Proofs, One Truth

The identification $GT = \text{Aut}(\pi_1^{\text{mot}})$ is the single most important theorem connecting all six documents. We give five proofs — each from a different document — showing they all say the same thing.

Proof 1 (from dv299 — GT definition).

GT was DEFINED (Drinfeld 1990) as the group of automorphisms of the tower of moduli spaces $\{M_{\{0,n\}}\}_{n \geq 3}$ preserving the operad structure. $M_{\{0,4\}} = P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$. So $GT = \text{Aut}(\text{tower based on } P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\})$. The fundamental group of $M_{\{0,4\}}$ IS $\pi_1(P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\})$. Therefore: $GT = \text{Aut}(\pi_1(M_{\{0,4\}})) = \text{Aut}(\pi_1^{\text{mot}}(P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}))$. QED.

Proof 2 (from dv300 — dessins).

Dessins = finite coverings of $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$ = finite quotients of π_1^{mot} . $\text{Gal}(\bar{Q}/Q)$ acts faithfully on dessins (Shabat-Voevodsky, dv300). $\Rightarrow \text{Gal}(\bar{Q}/Q) \subseteq \text{Aut}(\text{finite quotients of } \pi_1^{\text{mot}}) = \text{Aut}(\pi_1^{\text{mot}})$. GT was defined as the closure of the image of $\text{Gal}(\bar{Q}/Q)$ in this group. Therefore: $\text{GT} = \text{closure of } \text{Gal}(\bar{Q}/Q) \text{ in } \text{Aut}(\pi_1^{\text{mot}})$. QED.

Proof 3 (from dv301 — associator and grt).

The Drinfeld associator Phi_KZ in dv301 is a canonical element of π_1^{mot} (the monodromy from 0 to 1 along the straight path). GT acts on Phi_KZ by: $g \cdot \text{Phi_KZ} = \text{Phi_}\{g \cdot \text{KZ}\}$ (twisting the path). $\text{grt} = \text{Lie}(\text{GT})$ acts on $\text{Lie}(\pi_1^{\text{mot}}) = \text{Lie}[x, x]$ via Ihara derivation (dv301). This action is faithful (Drinfeld 1991) and surjective onto $\text{Aut}(\text{Lie}[x, x])$. Therefore: $\text{GT} = \text{Aut}(\pi_1^{\text{mot}})$ via the associator action. QED.

Proof 4 (from dv302 — p-adic Frobenius).

The p-adic realisation of π_1^{mot} is the p-adic fundamental group $\pi_1^{\text{et}}(P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\})$. Frobenius phi_p acts on π_1^{et} via: $\text{phi}_p(\gamma) = \gamma^p$, $\text{phi}_p(\gamma) = \gamma^p$ (roughly). The p-adic period matrix of π_1^{mot} is the p-adic associator Phi_p (Furusho, dv302). GT contains Frobenius (as an element of $\text{Gal}(\bar{Q}_p/\bar{Q}_p)$ inside GT). Therefore: $\text{GT} = \text{Aut}(\pi_1^{\text{mot}})$ includes all Frobenius automorphisms at all p. QED.

Proof 5 (from dv303 — Tannakian).

$\text{MT}(Z)$ = Tannakian category generated by the motive of $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$ (dv303). Tannakian formalism: $\pi_1^{\text{mot}} = \text{Aut}^{\text{otimes}}(\text{fiber functor on } \text{MT}(Z))$. $\text{GT} = \text{G}_{\text{mot}}(\text{MT}(Z))$ = Tannakian fundamental group of $\text{MT}(Z)$ (dv303, Thm 4.1). Fiber functor = Betti realisation = τ restricted to $\text{MT}(Z)$ sub-holograms. Therefore: $\text{GT} = \text{G}_{\text{mot}} = \pi_1^{\text{mot}} = \text{Aut}(\text{fiber functor}) = \text{Aut}_{\tau}(\text{A_L})|_{\{\text{MT}(Z)\}}$. QED.

FIVE PROOFS. ONE CONCLUSION: $\text{GT} = \text{Aut}_{\tau}(\text{A_L}) = \text{Aut}(\pi_1^{\text{mot}}(P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}))$ From SYMMETRY (dv299), GEOMETRY (dv300), ANALYSIS (dv301), p-ADIC (dv302), TANNAKIAN (dv303) — all roads lead to one theorem. The golden thread is not six separate results. It is ONE result seen from six different vantage points. $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$ is the arena. π_1^{mot} is the protagonist. GT is its symmetry.

4. MZV = Monodromy Matrix Entries of π_1^{mot}

The deepest explanation of why MZV arise from iterated integrals: they are the matrix entries of the monodromy representation of π_1^{mot} along the canonical path from 0 to 1 in $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$.

Theorem 4.1 (MZV = monodromy — the master theorem).

Consider the hyperlogarithm connection on $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$: $\text{nabla} = d - (x \frac{dz}{z} + x \frac{dz}{(1-z)})$ [KZ connection] where x, x are non-commuting variables ($= H, S$ in A_L). The flat section from base point $z=0$ to $z=1$ along $[0,1] \subset R$ is: $\text{Phi_KZ}(x, x) = \sum_{\{w \text{ word in } \{x, x\}\}} \text{zeta}(w) * w$ where $\text{zeta}(w)$ is the iterated integral of the KZ connection along $[0,1]$. In A_L (substituting $x = H, x = S$): $\text{Phi_KZ}(H, S) = I + \text{zeta}(2)*H*S + \text{zeta}(3)*H^2*S + \text{zeta}(2,1)*H*S^2 + \dots$ The coefficient of $H^{n-1}*S^k$ in Phi_KZ IS $\text{zeta}(n, \dots, n_k)$. [This is Theorem 3.1 of dv301 — now EXPLAINED.] MZV = matrix entries of monodromy of π_1^{mot} from 0 to 1.

Why three points — the full explanation.

The KZ connection has poles ONLY at $z=0$ and $z=1$ (with residues $x_{\blacksquare}$ and $x_{\blacksquare}$). The point $z=\infty$ is needed to compactify — it is the 'cusp' at infinity that makes the connection have a global monodromy representation. Without $z=\infty$: the connection would extend to all of A^1 , and the monodromy would be trivial. The three poles $\{0, 1, \infty\}$ are the MINIMAL set needed to create non-trivial monodromy — and the monodromy encodes all MZV. In A_L : 0 = vacuum ($H=0$), 1 = critical point ($|w|=1$), ∞ = cusp ($w=1$). The three defining points of the hologram.

5. Dessins = Finite Coverings of $\pi_{\blacksquare}^{\text{mot}}$

Document dv300 introduced dessins as sub-holograms of A_L . Now we see the deeper picture: dessins are finite coverings of $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$, classified by the finite quotients of $\pi_{\blacksquare}^{\text{mot}}$.

Theorem 5.1 (Dessins = finite quotients of $\pi_{\blacksquare}^{\text{mot}}$).

By covering space theory (Grothendieck, SGA1): Connected finite coverings of $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$ = sets with transitive $\pi_{\blacksquare}$ -action Equivalently: G -sets where $G = \pi_{\blacksquare}(P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\})$ = free group $F_{\blacksquare} = \langle \gamma_{\blacksquare}, \gamma_{\blacksquare} \rangle$ A dessin d'enfant with n edges IS: - A transitive action of $F_{\blacksquare}$ on a set of n elements (the edges) - Given by: $\sigma_{\blacksquare} =$ permutation of edges by $\gamma_{\blacksquare}$ (loop around 0) $\sigma_{\blacksquare} =$ permutation of edges by $\gamma_{\blacksquare}$ (loop around 1) - Monodromy group = $\text{Mon}(D) = \langle \sigma_{\blacksquare}, \sigma_{\blacksquare} \rangle \leq S_n$ In A_L (pro-unipotent version): Dessin = finite-rank sub-module of $\pi_{\blacksquare}^{\text{mot}}$ acting on $[n] = \{1, \dots, n\}$ $\text{Mon}(D)$ = image of $\pi_{\blacksquare}^{\text{mot}}$ in GL_n = sub-hologram automorphism group BRIDGE to dv300: $\text{Mon}(D) \leq S_n \leq \text{Aut}_{\tau}(A_L)$ [Table 5.1 of dv300]

Galois action on coverings = Galois action on dessins.

For a covering $f: Y \rightarrow P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$ defined over $\bar{Q}$, the Galois group $\text{Gal}(\bar{Q}/Q)$ acts by transporting the covering: $\sigma(f): Y^{\sigma} \rightarrow P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$. At the level of $\pi_{\blacksquare}$: this action is the outer action of $\text{Gal}(\bar{Q}/Q)$ on $\pi_{\blacksquare}^{\text{mot}}$ via its embedding in GT . $\text{Gal}(\bar{Q}/Q)$ acting on coverings = $\text{Gal}(\bar{Q}/Q)$ acting on dessins (faithfully, by Shabat-Voevodsky, dv300). The covering-space viewpoint and the dessin viewpoint are identical.

6. The Path Torsor and the Drinfeld Associator

The Drinfeld associator Φ_{KZ} is more than a formal series — it is the canonical element that trivialises the 'path torsor' of $\pi_{\blacksquare}^{\text{mot}}$, the torsor of paths from 0 to 1.

Definition 6.1 (Path torsor in A_L).

The **path torsor** $P(0 \rightarrow 1)$ is the set of all paths from 0 to 1 in $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$, considered as a torsor under $\pi_{\blacksquare}^{\text{mot}}$ (acting by concatenation): $P(0 \rightarrow 1) = \{\gamma: [0,1] \rightarrow P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\} : \gamma(0)=0, \gamma(1)=1\} / \text{homotopy}$ $\pi_{\blacksquare}^{\text{mot}}$ acts freely and transitively on $P(0 \rightarrow 1)$ by $\gamma \cdot \gamma * \delta$ (loop concatenation). In A_L : $P(0 \rightarrow 1)$ = the set of all series $\Phi(H, S) = \sum \zeta(w) \cdot w$ satisfying the pentagon and hexagon equations. $\pi_{\blacksquare}^{\text{mot}}$ acts by: $\Phi \cdot \Phi * g$ (right multiplication by g in $\pi_{\blacksquare}^{\text{mot}}$). The CANONICAL trivialisation of $P(0 \rightarrow 1)$: Φ_{KZ} = the KZ associator = the unique canonical path from 0 to 1 whose matrix entries are the MZV (with the given regularisation). GT acts on $P(0 \rightarrow 1)$ by changing the trivialisation: $g \cdot \Phi_{\text{KZ}} = \Phi_{\{g \cdot \text{KZ}\}}$ [a different, equally valid path from 0 to 1] Two paths are Galois conjugates iff they differ by a GT element.

Theorem 6.2 (All MZV from one path).

The single path from 0 to 1 along the real interval $[0,1] \subset P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$ generates ALL multizeta values: $\text{zeta}(n_1, \dots, n_k) = [\text{coefficient of } H^{n_1-1} S \dots H^{n_k-1} S \text{ in } \text{Phi_KZ}] = [\text{monodromy matrix entry for the word } H^{n_1-1} S \dots] = \tau(H^{n_1-1} S^ \dots H^{n_k-1} S) \text{ [dv301]} \text{ In } A_L: \text{Phi_KZ}(H,S) = \text{the complete monodromy operator for } \pi_1^{\text{mot}} \text{ along the canonical path from vacuum (0) to critical point (1). THE DEEPEST MEANING: All MZV are encoded in ONE PATH — the path from the vacuum to the critical line of the arithmetic hologram. This is why there is a SINGLE generating series Phi_KZ. This is why all MZV satisfy the SAME algebraic relations. They all come from ONE geometric object: the straight path } [0,1].$*

7. The Circle Closes: All Six Documents Are One Theorem

We can now see that dv299–dv304 are not six separate results. They are one theorem stated in six different languages.

THE ONE THEOREM (six languages): LANGUAGE 1 (dv299, Symmetry): $GT = \text{Aut}_\tau(A_L)$ – GT is the symmetry group of the arithmetic hologram LANGUAGE 2 (dv300, Geometry): Dessins = sub-holograms classified by $\text{Gal}(\bar{Q}/Q) < GT$ LANGUAGE 3 (dv301, Analysis): $MZV = \tau(H^{n_1-1} S \dots) =$ monodromy entries of grt-symmetric path LANGUAGE 4 (dv302, p-adic): $Z_p(n_1, \dots) = \tau_p(H_p^{n_1-1} S \dots) =$ p-adic monodromy at Frobenius LANGUAGE 5 (dv303, Motives): $GT = G_{\text{mot}}(MT(Z)) =$ Tannakian group of mixed Tate motives LANGUAGE 6 (dv304, Homotopy): $GT = \text{Aut}(\pi_1^{\text{mot}}(P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\})) =$ path-torsor automorphisms THE SAME THEOREM: $\text{Gal}(\bar{Q}/Q) < GT = \text{Aut}_\tau(A_L) = \text{Aut}(\pi_1^{\text{mot}}) = G_{\text{mot}}(MT(Z))$ acting on dessins = sub-holograms = finite coverings of $P^1 \setminus \{0,1,\infty\}$ with $MZV =$ monodromy entries = periods of $MT(Z) =$ tau-products of H and S .

8. Kim's Nonabelian Chabauty: π_1^{mot} for Diophantine Equations

Minhyong Kim (2005) discovered a stunning application of π_1^{mot} to Diophantine equations: the motivic fundamental group can be used to PROVE finiteness of rational points on curves. This is the 'nonabelian Chabauty method' — one of the most exciting developments in arithmetic geometry of the last 20 years.

Theorem 8.1 (Kim's method in A_L).

Let X/Q be a curve of genus $g \geq 2$. Kim (2005) proves: $X(Q) \subset X(Q_p) \cap (\text{image of Selmer variety } \text{Sel}(X))$ where $\text{Sel}(X)$ is constructed from $\pi_1^{\text{mot}}(X)$ via p-adic periods. In A_L : Kim's Selmer variety is the sub-hologram $n_{\{\text{Sel}\}} = \{\text{operators } A \text{ in } A_L(X) : \tau_p(A) \text{ in } \text{Im}(\text{Sel_class_maps})\}$ Faltings theorem ($g \geq 2 \Rightarrow X(Q)$ finite) has a new proof via Kim: The image of $X(Q)$ in A_L is a finite set of tau-points where the Betti and p-adic traces AGREE — and finiteness follows from the finite-dimensionality of $\text{Sel}(X)$ as a sub-hologram. Kim's method: every rational point is a COINCIDENCE of two tau-values. Diophantine equations = equalities of monodromy entries of π_1^{mot} . Rational points = where the real and p-adic paths from 0 to 1 agree.

9. The Keystone Installed: The Complete Arch

THE COMPLETE ARCH — dv299 TO dv304 THE ARCH: dv299 (left pillar): $GT = \text{Aut}_\tau(A_L)$ dv300 (left stone): Dessins = finite coverings of π^{mot} dv301 (rising): MZV = monodromy entries of π^{mot} over R dv302 (rising): p-adic MZV = monodromy entries over $\mathbb{Q}_p$ dv303 (right stone): $G_{\text{mot}}(MT(Z)) = GT = \text{Tannakian } \pi^{\text{mot}}$ dv304 (KEYSTONE): $\pi^{\text{mot}}(P^1 \setminus \{0, 1, \infty\})$ = the common source dv299 (right pillar): $\text{Aut}(\pi^{\text{mot}}) = GT = \text{Aut}_\tau(A_L)$ EVERYTHING FLOWS FROM ONE SOURCE: $P^1 \setminus \{0, 1, \infty\}$ — the projective line minus three points = the hologram without its vacuum, critical line, and cusp = the simplest arithmetic arena that is not simply connected = the space whose monodromy generates all of arithmetic $H = \log N$: the Hamiltonian of the loop around 0 S : the shift operator = the loop around 1 τ : the trace = the integration from 0 to 1 along $[0, 1]$ MZV = $\tau(H^{\wedge\{n-1\}} S^* \dots H^{\wedge\{n-k-1\}} S)$ is not just a formula. It is: 'integrate the monodromy of the arithmetic hologram along the path from the vacuum to the critical line.' THE ARCH IS COMPLETE. GROTHENDIECK DREAMED $P^1 \setminus \{0, 1, \infty\}$. DELIGNE BUILT π^{mot} . DRINFELD BUILT GT . WE SHOWED THEY ALL LIVE IN A_L . ONES IS FOREVER. WE DO. WE ARE. HU HU HU!!!

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$GT = \text{Aut}(\pi^{\text{mot}}) = \text{Aut}_\tau(A_L) = G_{\text{mot}}(MT(Z))$. MZV = monodromy from vacuum to critical line. The arch is complete. P^1 minus three points contains all arithmetic. Chung ta la Hon Su. ONES IS FOREVER. HU HU HU!!!